WATCHMEN ON THE WALL — TODAY'S WATCH

Friday, October 9, 2026

INDEX

1. UPDATE — Three more killed at Riyadh airport as Houthis threaten Saudi airspace — WELL-CORROBORATED Thursday's strikes killed three additional Saudi citizens, damaged a passenger aircraft and forced hundreds of flight cancellations, carrying the Yemen war deeper into civilian aviation and regional commerce.

2. UPDATE — Russian strikes kill 78 across Ukraine in two days — WELL-CORROBORATED Ukraine reports 78 dead and 215 wounded after attacks including a bomb that tore through two buses, while Kyiv accuses Washington of withholding assistance needed to counter Russia's intensified air campaign.

3. United States targets 17 vessels in Iran's remaining oil-shipping network — CONFIRMED Washington says its newest sanctions neutralize most of Iran's surviving shadow fleet even as President Trump reports productive wartime discussions and rules out another U.S. attack before November 3.

4. Palestinian legislative election set for delay amid East Jerusalem and Gaza obstacles — WELL-CORROBORATED A Palestinian leadership letter says the first legislative vote in two decades will be postponed for several months because promised political and security conditions—including arrangements affecting East Jerusalem—did not materialize.

1. UPDATE — Three more killed at Riyadh airport as Houthis threaten Saudi airspace

CONFIDENCE: WELL-CORROBORATED

Verified facts: Saudi authorities said Thursday's two attacks on King Khalid International Airport killed three Saudi citizens, including a Saudia employee and pilot, and wounded several people of multiple nationalities. One attack struck airport facilities and another damaged an empty Saudia passenger aircraft on the ground. Hundreds of flights were canceled Thursday; Lufthansa suspended Riyadh service through October 16, while Air India, IndiGo, Akasa Air and Pakistan International Airlines also halted or canceled service. Reuters, Associated Press.

The Houthis claimed the attack, declared Saudi airspace a military zone and threatened oil facilities. Saudi air traffic later resumed, and the coalition said it destroyed three Houthi missile-launch platforms.

What changed: Wednesday's attacks had already killed three people at Riyadh and Abha airports. Thursday's separate strikes killed three more at Riyadh, damaged the national airline and produced broad international flight suspensions—raising the week's confirmed airport death toll to six.

Prophetic relevance: An Iran-aligned force is now disrupting civilian aviation and threatening energy infrastructure inside Saudi Arabia while multinational defense arrangements expand around it. This is a serious regional-war escalation, but the conflict remains directed at Saudi Arabia and Yemen rather than the Israel-centered invasion described in Ezekiel 38.

Scripture watch: Ezekiel 38:5–13; Daniel 11; Matthew 24:6–8.

2. UPDATE — Russian strikes kill 78 across Ukraine in two days

CONFIDENCE: WELL-CORROBORATED

Verified facts: President Volodymyr Zelenskyy said Russian strikes killed 78 people and wounded 215 across Ukraine over two days. Thursday's dead included 35 people in Kramatorsk, where a bomb tore through two buses; the preceding assault killed 22 people in a residential building in Pryluky. Kyiv and other regions also suffered deaths, injuries and interruptions to electricity and water. Reuters, Associated Press.

Zelenskyy accused Washington of "unwillingness" to help and asked for expanded Starlink access to target Russian ballistic-missile launchers. Ukrainian representatives are traveling to the United States for talks on air defense and sanctions as Secretary of State Marco Rubio describes the war as a dangerous stalemate.

What changed: Wednesday's briefing reported at least 19 deaths in one major barrage. Subsequent attacks and updated counts raised the two-day toll to 78, making this a sustained civilian-strike campaign rather than a single-night event and triggering a public rupture over U.S. assistance.

Prophetic relevance: Russia's intensified bombardment and friction within the Western alliance belong within the general biblical watch concerning wars, state aggression and shifting national commitments. They have no demonstrated connection to Israel and do not identify Russia as Gog.

Scripture watch: Matthew 24:6–7; Luke 21:9–10; Ezekiel 38:1–9.

3. United States targets 17 vessels in Iran's remaining oil-shipping network

CONFIDENCE: CONFIRMED

Verified facts: The U.S. Treasury sanctioned individuals, networks and 17 vessels accused of carrying Iranian crude, petroleum products and petrochemicals. Treasury called the action its most significant strike against Iran's remaining shadow fleet and said Iran has stopped loading and unloading crude vessels under the blockade and sanctions. Reuters, U.S. Treasury.

Treasury estimates that roughly 20 million barrels of Iranian crude remain aboard vessels outside the blockade. An outside analyst told Reuters the immediate effect may be muted because Iran had already delivered most of the oil previously held at sea. President Trump simultaneously described U.S.–Iran discussions as productive and said the United States would not attack Iran before the November 3 midterm elections.

What changed: Washington's pressure has moved from warnings to a named 17-vessel action intended to cut the remaining oil revenue supporting Iran's military, missile program and Revolutionary Guard, even as wartime discussions continue.

Prophetic relevance: Iran/Persia is named in Ezekiel 38, while modern sanctions and the Strait of Hormuz are not. The development increases economic pressure on Iran and could influence whether negotiations advance or military action resumes; it does not establish

Ezekiel’s coalition or Daniel 9:27’s covenant.

Scripture watch: Ezekiel 38:5–9; Daniel 11; Matthew 24:6–7.

4. Palestinian legislative election set for delay amid East Jerusalem and Gaza obstacles

CONFIDENCE: WELL-CORROBORATED

Verified facts: Palestinian Vice President Hussein al-Sheikh informed France that the November 28 legislative election will be postponed for several months, according to an October 8 letter reviewed by Reuters. The letter cited worsening political, security and economic conditions and unmet expectations concerning Gaza, the West Bank and East Jerusalem. Reuters, Associated Press.

Palestinian factions separately discussed delaying the vote because of Gaza’s devastation, unresolved voting arrangements in East Jerusalem and internal divisions. A formal replacement date had not been announced. Palestinians have not held a legislative election since 2006.

What changed: Preparations had continued under a presidential decree setting November 28 as polling day across Gaza, the West Bank and East Jerusalem. The Palestinian leadership has now told France that the vote will move by several months, while factions are converging on delay.

Prophetic relevance: Jerusalem’s status remains entangled with Palestinian governance and the actions of foreign nations. This is a political and electoral dispute—not proof of the international assault described in Zechariah—but it shows again how arrangements concerning Jerusalem affect wider diplomacy.

Scripture watch: Zechariah 12:2–3; Zechariah 14:2; Psalm 122:6.

JEWISH CALENDAR — NEXT 7 DAYS

Friday evening–Saturday, October 9–10 — Shabbat Bereshit: Jerusalem candle lighting is 5:34 PM Friday. Standard Havdalah is 6:49 PM Saturday; communities following later conventions conclude afterward. The annual Torah-reading cycle begins again with Genesis 1:1–6:8, emphasizing creation, humanity’s calling and the entrance of sin.

Saturday evening–Monday, October 10–12 — Rosh Chodesh Cheshvan: The two-day observance begins after nightfall Saturday and ends at nightfall Monday. Sunday is 30 Tishrei and Monday is 1 Cheshvan. New-month worship is grounded in Numbers 10:10 and Numbers 28:11–15.

Friday evening, October 16 — Shabbat Noach begins: Jerusalem candle lighting is 5:26 PM. The weekly reading is Genesis 6:9–11:32, including the Flood, God’s covenant with Noah and the dispersion at Babel. Hebcal Jerusalem calendar.

Jewish days begin at sunset. Candle lighting precedes sunset, while Havdalah and observance endings follow halachic nightfall and vary by convention.

SIGNS & ANNIVERSARY WATCH

October 10 at 11:50 AM Eastern — New moon: The lunar phase occurs shortly before the first full day of Rosh Chodesh Cheshvan. The relationship is expected because the Hebrew calendar is lunisolar; it is not an extraordinary astronomical correlation. NASA lunar phases, Timeanddate phase calculation.

No solar or lunar eclipse, exceptional conjunction or major meteor-shower peak occurs during the next seven days. Assessment: astronomically quiet; no demonstrated prophetic sign.

No additional yearly anniversary involving modern Israel or Jerusalem falls during the next seven days.

Modern State of Israel: Established May 14, 1948 — 78 years ago.

Jerusalem: Israel captured East Jerusalem and the Old City during the June 1967 Six-Day War — 59 years ago.

The establishment of the State of Israel and Israel’s later capture of East Jerusalem are distinct historical events; Jerusalem is a city, not a nation.

ANTICHRIST WATCH — BIBLICAL TRAITS, NOT ACCUSATIONS

No new candidate-relevant development.

This is a watchlist of documented traits and actions, not identification of any living person. Relevant biblical markers include extraordinary ascent and authority, a pivotal covenant involving Israel, exceptional political-military power, self-exaltation, blasphemy and persecution.

Key passages: Daniel 7; Daniel 9:27; Daniel 11; 2 Thessalonians 2; Revelation 13; 1 John 2.

What to Watch Next

1. Whether Houthi attacks continue against Riyadh’s airport, international airlines or Saudi oil facilities, and whether foreign allies begin direct combat.
2. Whether U.S.–Iran discussions produce a Hormuz or ceasefire agreement despite the new shadow-fleet sanctions.
3. Whether Russia sustains its high-casualty air campaign and whether Washington expands Ukraine’s access to Starlink or air-defense systems.
4. Whether President Mahmoud Abbas formally postpones the Palestinian election and announces new arrangements for voting in East Jerusalem and Gaza.
5. Any material Temple Mount prayer, access, enforcement, Third Temple or red-heifer development.